



Alternate source: "One way to make money is to create courses which can be sold. For sustainability, this is fine. I think it will grow more in the coming days," says Thejkumar, India's 50th Grandmaster and the first from Karnataka.

fallen off the radar. **Parimarjan Negi** was the second-youngest in history to receive the title in 2006. He quit chess to focus on academics. After graduating from Stanford University and then Massachusetts Institute of Technology, he now works as a software engineer in the United States. But Negi's decision is more a personal decision than a byproduct of circumstance. "If you are not in the top 100 in the world, it's better to look for alternative careers within chess. The

market for non-GM trainers is shrinking. Parents want children to learn from GMs even at a beginner level," Ramesh says. Thejkumar adds another suggestion. "Another way to make money is to create courses which can be sold. For sustainability, this is fine. I think it will grow more in the coming days," he says. "I see many youngsters becoming social media influencers; some are writing books. That is also becoming an alternative career," Ramesh opines. "In India, we have a huge

population, so if you are an influencer, you can still make good money. People are creating their own opportunities." Chess' popularity in India is still on an upward curve. Vijayalakshmi, Debashis, and Thejkumar — all believe there is still space for chess to grow in the hinterlands. There are still adequate opportunities, at least for GMs, to make a steady living from the game. But the rate at which we are producing GMs might soon eclipse the demand. Coaches, influencers and others will soon have to offer something extra to remain in vogue. Otherwise, the uncertainty surrounding their future in the sphere might swallow them up and leave them in limbo.



Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Black defence', published in the issue dated September 26, 2026

Key 1.exf7!

1...Nd4 2.Qd6;
1...d5 2.f7xe8Q;
1...Kf6 2.f7xe8N;
1...Kf8 2.fxg8Q;
1.....Kxd7 2.f8N;
1..Rxd8 2.cxd8Q
1...Rf8 2.f7xg8N;
1...Bxf7 2.Rf7;
1...Bh7 2.f8Q



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